

Mixing Audio

Learning Objectives

- Combine multiple audio tracks into one
- Adjust volume levels and balance between tracks
- Use the timeline to align audio elements

Engage (5-7 minutes)

Think of a film song where voices, drums, flutes, and background music blend perfectly. A music mixer balances all these tracks so nothing overpowers the other. Today we learn to mix audio like a studio engineer.

Explore (10-12 minutes)

Open two audio files in Audacity—one voice recording and one background music. Select both and play them together. Notice which is louder. Use the volume slider on each track to balance them. Write what settings worked best.

Explain (10-12 minutes)

Mixing combines multiple tracks into a single output. Each track has independent volume and pan controls. The timeline shows all tracks stacked vertically—align them so sounds happen at the right time. Balance means no single track dominates the mix.

Elaborate (8-10 minutes)

Create a podcast-style clip: your voice narrating over soft background music. Import both tracks, lower the music volume to 30%, keep voice at 100%. Align the start points. Mix and export the final result.

Evaluate (5-8 minutes)

Exit ticket: Explain what mixing means in audio editing. Name two controls used to balance tracks in a mix.